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EMBASSY OF THE
UNITED STATES OF AMERICA

No. 374 Chungking, April 16, 1942

Subject: Chinese Reaction to Rear-Admiral Yarnell's "Message to the People of China".

FE memorandum June 2, 1942. Letter drafted by RS to Adm Yarnell June 2. KLS

Air Mail

June 3, 1942

Division of FAR EASTERN AFFAIRS MAY 19 Department of State

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DIVISION OF COMMUNICATIONS AND RECORDS

ADVISER ON POLITICAL RELATIONS MR. HORNBECK JUN 2 - 1942 DEPARTMENT OF STATE

740.0011 PW/2465

The Honorable,
The Secretary of State,
Washington, D. C.

740.0011 PACIFIC WAR/2465 PS/ET

Sir:

I have the honor to refer to an address made by Rear-Admiral Harry E. Yarnell, U.S.N. Retired, at San Francisco on April 2, 1942, which has been reported as a "message to the people of China". I enclose what is 1/ stated to be the full text of the address as cabled to China by the Office of the Coordinator of Information for dissemination in this country by the American Information Service through the CENTRAL NEWS AGENCY.

Because Admiral Yarnell is well-known in China and because the sentiments he expressed are exactly what the Chinese themselves most desire, his speech received great prominence in all Chinese newspapers, and was widely and 2/ extravagantly commented upon. I enclose a copy of an item from the official CENTRAL NEWS AGENCY dated April 4, entitled "Admiral Yarnell's Message Well Received Here", and, 3/ as typical of Chinese editorial comment, a translation of an editorial from the TA KUNG PAO of April 6.

FILED JUN 18 1942

I believe this editorial to be worthy of special notice, not only because of the importance and reliability as a reflection of Chinese opinion of the paper in which it was published, but also because of the way it seizes upon Admiral Yarnell's statements and carries them to a logical

conclusion

conclusion. Admiral Yarnell spoke only of India and Burma: the article speaks of freedom for the Liuchiu Islands, the Netherlands East Indies and the Philippines as well. The Admiral said that: "(The peoples of the world) are not merely saving themselves from Japan, Germany and Italy. They are establishing for all time the principle that they shall have freedom..." The (extraterritorial) treaties with China should be canceled now by the Allied Nations". The TA KUNG PAO says: "We (Chinese) are fighting for ourselves - not to help one imperialism defeat another imperialism** China suffered under foreign oppression for a hundred years and was reduced by it to a semi-colonial status. *** We should clearly tell the world that, as we are fighting now against the aggressors, so in the future we will not endure the continuance of any sort of oppression: nor continue to exist in a semi-colonial status. *** The British and American promises that they will give up their special rights in China after the war are really only bank checks. They should be cashed now."

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4/ I also enclose original and translation of a letter addressed by the Formosan Revolutionary League (see my despatch no. 342 of March 31, 1942) to Admiral Yarnell in my care. The sending of this message was reported by the CENTRAL NEWS AGENCY on April 5. The Department is requested to make such disposition of it as seems appropriate.

I do not know the occasion for Admiral Yarnell's statement, but I question the wisdom of its being made by a person of his prominence, and given publicity through official American channels, at the present time when the question of the future status of all colonial possessions in the Far East is of such delicacy and when the Chinese are giving many indications of a desire to take unilateral action restrictive of present and future American interests in this country.

Respectfully yours,

C. E. Gauss

5 Enclosures:

1/ Text of Admiral Yarnell's "Message to the People".
2/ CENTRAL NEWS AGENCY's news comment dated April 4.
3/ Translation of editorial from TA KUNG PAO dated April 6.
4/ Original and translation of letter from Formosan Revolutionary League.

Original and two copies to the Department by air.
Two copies to the Department by pouch.

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JSS/wr

Enclosure no. 1 to despatch no. 374 dated April 16, 1942 from American Embassy at Chungking.

(C O P Y)

YARNELL CALLS FOR PACIFIC CHARTER NOW

SAN FRANCISCO, April 2(Central)- Rear-Admiral Harry Yarnell, U.S.N. retired, today called for a Pacific Charter in a stirring message addressed to the people of China. In this message he declared that the basic principle of this charter must be the welfare and political freedom of the masses. A strong government in China, he said, is the foundation of peace in the Far East. Admiral Yarnell, one-time commander of the U.S. Asiatic Fleet, categorically stated that after the war all extraterritorial rights in China will be abolished. He spoke of the "inevitability" of independence for India and Burma. The full text of his address reads:

"Stated in its simplest terms, the fundamental issue of this war is the alleged right of any nation to subjugate and rule the people of other nations. On one side we find three nations who have reverted to the world's earliest theories and practices of tyranny and despotism. For justification they claim mysterious God-given racial superiority over all other peoples. And regardless of justification they have built war machines capable of dominating the whole world unless there is the most determined and powerful resistance in human history.

"On the other side we find most of the rest of the peoples of the world, in varying stages of their progress on the road to democracy and self-rule. Whatever their present status, they face the immediate menace of conquest and living conditions worse than ever known before. These peoples have banded themselves together under the name United Nations to fight against this menace. But in doing this, they are necessarily doing more. It is clear they are facing the fundamental issue I have named. They are not merely saving themselves from Japan, Germany and Italy. They are establishing for all time the principle that the people of the world shall have freedom and the right to order their own lives.

"It is for this reason that what is called the Atlantic Charter has been ratified by the United Nations, asserting in unmistakable language the right of all peoples to choose their own form of government and give all peoples who have not self-government this basic right. For the same reason, President Roosevelt enunciated his words regarding the four freedoms and stated that these freedoms as well as the Atlantic Charter apply to the Pacific and the whole world.

"It

"It is becoming increasingly evident that these statements of post-war policy, far-reaching as they are, need the supporting buttress of specific points relating to the Far East. Thus, it is necessary to secure the whole-hearted support of the Eastern peoples to the cause of the United Nations. What may be called a Pacific Charter is necessary today. Let us consider briefly what the outstanding features of such a charter should be.

"The basic principle of a Pacific Charter must be the welfare and political freedom of the masses of the people. The day of colonial exploitation of nations by other nations is gone.

"The foundation of peace in the Far East is a strong, stable, liberal government in China. To this end it is essential that China emerge victorious in this war in which she has suffered so terribly and yet has fought on for five years with courage and endurance without precedent in history. It would be a major catastrophe if this age-old civilization should go down in defeat. The post-war problems that will confront a victorious China will be tremendous. Yet if the guiding principle of welfare of the masses is kept foremost in mind, then the problems can be solved.

"China would have been defeated in a few months in 1937 had the people not realized the danger of ruthless foreign domination and rallied behind the government. After the war is over, the government can succeed in the task of establishing unity, stability and prosperity only by recognizing and following the basic policy of promoting the welfare of the masses of the people. Naturally China will have complete independence. Extra-territoriality, foreign concessions and all special concessions and privileges of past treaties will be abolished. These treaties should be cancelled now by the allied nations.

"The next great problem in the post-war settlement is that of Japan. Here we have a nation dominated by medieval ideas of force, imbued with belief in their racial superiority and their right to dominate other peoples in the Far East. Their colonial record as far as their subject peoples are concerned is one of exploitation, brutality and denial of all political rights.

"These subject peoples are hewers of wood and drawers of water. The profits go to the Mitsuis, Mitsubishis and the military. The common people of Japan probably never benefited in the slightest from the expansion by force that has been the policy of the Japanese government since the restoration (by Emperor Meiji.) They have furnished cannon folder and paid the bills of crushing armaments.

"Japanese domination of their colonies is maintained only by military force. Remove the garrisons and there would be revolution overnight. When the war is over

Japan must be deprived of the colonies she has gained by force. Korea must be given independence. Manchuria and Formosa must revert to China since the population is over 95 per cent Chinese. The Marshall and Caroline Islands must be placed under a mandate that will ensure the welfare of the natives. It seems inevitable that India and Burma receive independence. Definite commitments of great value have already been made in this direction. On the whole and for many years, the rule of Great Britain and the Netherlands in the Far East has been kindly and tolerant. Peace and order have been maintained with a minimum of force. Much has been done for the people and there has been no such exploitation, tyranny and brutality as has been experienced in Korea and other Japanese colonies.

"Yet the day has come when the primary principle of government must be welfare of the people and not profit to the mother country. Indo-China must be placed under a mandate that will be guided by this primary principle. The Philippines will receive independence in 1946 and the United States will carry on the war until that aim is achieved.

"There are other great problems to be solved at the Peace Conference--notably markets and raw materials. It would seem that a customs union of some sort embracing the Far East could be arranged that would satisfy the necessities of Japan for outlet of her manufactured goods. Also there must be access by all nations to raw materials of the world on equal terms.

"This is what I consider should be the basis of the Pacific Charter, Its future success in preserving peace and meeting the demands of the Far Eastern peoples for improvement of their physical and political welfare will call for the highest wisdom on the part of the United Nations. Success also obviously depends on the eventual victory of China and the other United Nations in the present war.

"For this reason China can rely on the determination of the allies to see this war through to a successful end."

(True copy:
(Compared:

Enclosure no. 2 to despatch no. 374 dated April 16, 1942 from American Embassy at Chungking.

(C O P Y)

ADMIRAL YARNELL'S MESSAGE WELL RECEIVED HERE

Chungking, April 4 (Central): Rear-Admiral Harry E. Yarnell's message to the people of China, prominently displayed in Chungking papers, was received exceedingly well by the general public.

The idea of a Pacific Charter has been the subject of wide discussion in Chungking and prominent leaders like Dr. Sun Fo, president of the Legislative Yuan, publicly gave his support some time ago.

The immediate abolition of extraterritoriality and foreign connections, as suggested by Rear-Admiral Yarnell, will be timely. Formerly when China's allies like the United States and Britain were not yet at war with Japan, it was necessary to defer the execution, as it might bring undue pressure on American and British residents in China. With the coming of the war, however, this necessity has disappeared, according to comments in political circles.

The same circles add that Rear-Admiral Yarnell's suggestion for the return of Formosa to China has expressed the tacit desire of the Formosans. If a plebiscite is taken in Formosa, the returns will prove that Rear-Admiral Yarnell's suggestion is the natural consequence of the application of one of the provisions in the Atlantic Charter.

(True copy:
(Compared: }

Enclosure no. 3 to despatch no. 374 dated April 16, 1942 from American Embassy at Chungking.

Translation of editorial from TA KUNG PAO, Chungking, of April 6, 1942.

IN APPROVAL OF THE PROPOSAL FOR A PACIFIC CHARTER

Admiral Yarnell's statement, in his message of April 3 to the Chinese people, that there should be a Pacific Charter is a most welcome one. He said: "The day of colonies is past, and the foundation of peace in the Orient is a strong and free government of China. To that end all extraterritorial rights should be abrogated and the Allied Nations should immediately take steps to abolish the treaties which created them." This statement of Admiral Yarnell's has our complete approval and we wish to make a few statements in explanation of China's attitude.

1. When Roosevelt and Churchill drew up their Atlantic Charter, war in the Pacific had not yet broken out and while their two countries were sympathetic with China, they were unable specifically to name Japan as the common enemy of the democracies. But, though in spirit that Charter embraced the Pacific, its extension to that area has been left in doubt because so many of the peoples of the Pacific have a colonial or semi-colonial status. Some, therefore, feel that it does not include the peoples of this part of the world. Take, for instance, India and Burma, both British colonies. What is to be their status after this war? To settle these questions, we feel that the demand for a Pacific charter is most timely. If we are to take literally Admiral Yarnell's words, it is not only Japan's colonies, Korea, the Liuchius and Formosa, that will be freed but also England's colonies such as India, Burma, Malaya, and the Dutch East Indies and the Philippines. If we had such a clear enunciation of war aims, much of the difficulty now being met in the settlement of the Indian problem would be obviated.

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2. As for China, we can frankly say to our friends as well as our enemies that China's motivating spirit in her resistance has been her own self-interest. We are fighting for ourselves - not to help one imperialism defeat another imperialism. China has suffered Japanese aggression and has resisted it: but China suffered under other foreign oppression for one hundred years and was reduced by it to a semi-colonial status. Many of the vestiges of this status remain and like the other aggression, are bound to meet Chinese resistance. To what end did Sun Yat-sen lead the revolution? Why has Chiang Kai-shek led our war of resistance? Both fought for the preservation of the people and the liberty of the nation! For what have the Chinese people striven for the past

half

half century, and shed so much blood during the past five years? Also for the same objective! Japan's attack on China aimed at our destruction. We naturally fought back - and must keep on fighting until the ultimate victory is gained. But we should also clearly tell the world that, as we are fighting now against the aggressors, so in the future we will not endure the continuance of any sort of oppression: nor continue to exist in a semi-colonial state. The cancellation of the unequal treaties which Admiral Yarnell advocates is exactly what China has been striving for so vigorously for. Although America and England have promised that they will give up their special rights in China after the war, in actuality these are still only bank checks. They should be cashed now.

3. The peoples of the Orient must clearly realize one thing. That Japan, from first to last, is an imperialistic power, worshipping brute force and knowing only self interest. Under her domination there are only slaves. To realize this we need only look at Korea, Formosa and the treatment of the people of occupied China. Her propaganda of "Asia for the Asiatics" is a deceiving lie. It really means "Asia for the Japanese". It is unavoidable, perhaps, that a few people such as the Burmans will be taken in by these false promises; and even in Burma we wonder how many have actually rallied to the Japanese. But small as the number may be, it is a tragedy because even they are working against the liberation of their own country. England in reality is only paying the price of history and it is the status in which England has held the Burmans which has given Japanese propaganda its appeal. This can be overcome if Admiral Yarnell's advice of a promise of freedom to all nationalities is followed. The spirit of the Pacific charter must be that of national freedom and equality for all peoples. These are the goals of China's fight. These should be likewise the goals of the United Nations struggle against aggression.

JSS/gws/mcl

(True copy:)
(Compared:)

Enclosure no. 4 to despatch no. 374 dated April 16, 1942 from American Embassy at Chungking.

Express letter (in lieu of telegram)
from Formosan Revolutionary League
To Admiral Yarnell, care of Ambassador
C.E.Gauss, American Embassy

Dated: April 5, 1942

Recd.: April 7, 1942
Trans. : Hsi 4/7/42
Checked: JSS 4/9/42
Typed : MCL 4/16/42

Admiral Yarnell:

We have just noted from the press Your Excellency's letter to the Chinese people. We admire and appreciate very much Your Excellency's opinion that Formosa should be returned to China. Under the leadership of this League, all Formosans are striving for this purpose and have been greatly encouraged by your support. On behalf of the six million Formosans, we respectfully thank you for your kindness and earnestly request that Your Excellency be good enough to guide us in the Formosan revolutionary movement.

Formosan Revolutionary League,

5th,

SEAL.